UP-PCS PRELIMS 2026 Â· HIGH PROBABILITY QUESTION BANK

# Master Expected Questions — Part 6

High-Yield Questions 376 to 450 (Random Subject Distribution with UPPSC Traps & Ratta Points)

**QUESTION RANGE**
Questions 376 – 450

**PATTERN & STYLE**
UPPSC 2024â€"2025 Standard (Statements, A&R, Match Lists)

**STUDY FORMAT**
Question â†' Options â†' Answer â†' In-Depth Ratta & Trap Notes

**TARGET DATE**
December 6 Prelims Examination

# UPPCS Prelims 2026 Expected Questions — Part 6 (Q376 to Q450)

**Subject Distribution:** Randomized Full-Spectrum GS (History, Geography, Polity, Science, Environment, Economy, UP Special, Current Affairs)
**Exam Standard:** Multi-statement, Assertion-Reason, Match Lists & Direct Factual Traps as per UPPSC 2024–2025 Trends

## Question 376

**Subject:** Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Landmark Peasant Satyagrahas Chronology

Arrange the following peasant movements in chronological order: 1. Indigo Revolt (Neel Bidroha) in Bengal 2. Deccan Riots in Maharashtra 3. Champaran Satyagraha in Bihar 4. Bardoli Satyagraha in Gujarat

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
B. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
C. 1 — 3 — 2 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** 1. **Indigo Revolt (1859–1860):** Started in Nadia, Bengal, led by Digambar Biswas and Bishnu Biswas against oppressive European indigo planters. 2. **Deccan Riots (1875):** Agrarian uprising in Pune and Ahmednagar districts of Maharashtra against Marwari and Gujarati moneylenders (*Sahukars*); led to the Deccan Agriculturists' Relief Act, 1879. 3. **Champaran Satyagraha (1917):** First Civil Disobedience in India led by Mahatma Gandhi against the Tinkathia indigo system. 4. **Bardoli Satyagraha (1928):** Led by **Vallabhbhai Patel** against a 22% unjust enhancement of land revenue in Surat district; its success earned Patel the title of **"Sardar"** conferred by the women of Bardoli. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mahatma Gandhi conferred the title "Sardar" on Vallabhbhai Patel on behalf of the women of Bardoli!

## Question 377

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Constitutional Amendment Procedure (Article 368)

Which of the following constitutional provisions requires an amendment by a **Special Majority of Parliament AND Ratification by not less than one-half of the State Legislatures** by simple majority? 1. Election of the President and its manner (Articles 54 & 55) 2. Extent of the executive power of the Union and the States (Articles 73 & 162) 3. Representation of States in Parliament 4. Any of the Lists in the Seventh Schedule

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 3 and 4 only
C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Under Article 368(2), federal provisions can be amended ONLY by a **Special Majority of Parliament** (majority of total membership of each House and $\ge ↟rac{2}{3}$ of members present & voting) **PLUS Ratification by the legislatures of at least 50% of the States** by simple majority. - **Entrenched Federal Provisions:** - Election of President and manner (Articles 54, 55). - Extent of executive power of Union and States (Articles 73, 162). - Supreme Court and High Courts (Part V Chap IV, Part VI Chap V, Article 241). - Distribution of legislative powers (Seventh Schedule Lists). - Representation of States in Parliament (Fourth Schedule). - Provisions of Article 368 itself! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Fundamental Rights (Part III) and DPSPs (Part IV) require ONLY a Special Majority of Parliament, and DO NOT require ratification by States!

## Question 378

**Subject:** Geography of India | **Topic:** Indian Biosphere Reserves & Unique Flora/Fauna

Match List-I (Biosphere Reserve) with List-II (State & Key Ecological Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Reserve)** A. Nokrek Biosphere Reserve
B. Similipal Biosphere Reserve

C. Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve
D. Achanakmar-Amarkantak

**List-II (Location & Feature)** 1. Odisha (Mayurbhanj); famous for melanistic (black) tigers and sal forests
2. Meghalaya (Garo Hills); gene sanctuary for wild citrus species (*Citrus indica*)
3. Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh border; source of Narmada, Son, and Johilla rivers
4. Western Ghats (Kerala and Tamil Nadu border); home to the ancient Kanikkar tribe

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Nokrek (Garo Hills, Meghalaya):** Located on the highest peak of Garo Hills (1,412 m); global gene sanctuary for wild mandarin orange (*Citrus indica*); red panda habitat. - **Similipal (Mayurbhanj, Odisha):** Encompasses pristine sal forests; only habitat of unique wild **melanistic (black) tigers**; part of UNESCO MAB. - **Agasthyamalai (Kerala/TN):** Home to over 2,000 species of medicinal plants and the indigenous Kanikkar hunter-gatherer tribe. - **Achanakmar-Amarkantak:** Straddles MP (Anuppur/Dindori) and Chhattisgarh (Bilaspur); crucial watershed separating drainage into Arabian Sea (Narmada), Bay of Bengal (Mahanadi), and Ganga (Son). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve is located in **Himachal Pradesh** (Pin Valley, Chandratal, Sarchu, Kibber)! Dehang-Debang is in **Arunachal Pradesh**; Dihru-Saikhowa is in **Assam**!

## Question 379

**Subject:** General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Pineal & Thymus Gland Physiology

Consider the following statements regarding the human endocrine glands: 1. The Pineal gland secretes the hormone 'Melatonin', which regulates the 24-hour diurnal rhythm (sleep-wake cycle) and body temperature. 2. The Thymus gland secretes 'Thymosins', which play a major role in the differentiation and maturation of T-lymphocytes (cell-mediated immunity). 3. The Thymus gland is large in infants and children, but progressively degenerates and atrophies in old age, leading to weakened immune responses in the elderly.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Pineal Gland:** Located on the dorsal side of the forebrain; called the "third eye"; secretes **Melatonin** in darkness (inhibited by light); regulates the sleep-wake cycle, metabolism, skin pigmentation, and menstrual cycles. - **Thymus Gland:** Lobular gland located behind the sternum on the ventral side of the aorta; acts as the primary lymphoid organ where **T-lymphocytes mature and acquire immunological competence** ("Training School of T-cells"). - **Age Atrophy:** Unlike other endocrine glands, the thymus shrinks steadily after puberty and is largely replaced by adipose tissue in old age, which explains the heightened susceptibility of senior citizens to infectious diseases. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** T-cells mature in the **Thymus**; B-cells mature in the **Bone Marrow**!

## Question 380

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Child Sex Ratio (0–6 Years) in UP (Census 2011)

Consider the following statements regarding the Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years) in Uttar Pradesh: 1. The Child Sex Ratio of Uttar Pradesh in Census 2011 was recorded at 902 girls per 1,000 boys (down from 916 in 2001). 2. Balrampur district recorded the highest Child Sex Ratio in Uttar Pradesh (950 girls per 1,000 boys). 3. Baghpat district recorded the lowest Child Sex Ratio in Uttar Pradesh (841 girls per 1,000 boys).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **State Average:** UP Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years) = **902** (14-point decline from 916 in 2001, below India's 919). - **Top 3 Districts (Highest Child Sex Ratio):** 1. **Balrampur (950)** 2. Sant Kabir Nagar (942) 3. Siddharthnagar (935) - **Bottom 3 Districts (Lowest Child Sex Ratio):** 1. **Baghpat (841)** 2. Gautam Buddha Nagar (843) 3. Ghaziabad (850) - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In Overall Sex Ratio, Jaunpur is #1 (1024); but in **Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years), Balrampur is #1 (950)**! Lowest Child Sex Ratio is in Baghpat (841).

## Question 381

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Polar Stratospheric Clouds & Ozone Hole

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

**Assertion (A):** The Antarctic ozone hole appears prominently each year in the months of September and October (Antarctic spring). **Reason (R):** In the extreme winter cold of Antarctica, Polar Stratospheric Clouds (PSCs) provide surfaces for stable chlorine reservoirs to convert into reactive chlorine radicals, which are rapidly released by sunlight in spring to trigger catalytic ozone destruction.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Antarctic Winter (June–August):** Circum-polar vortex isolates Antarctic air; temperatures plunge below $-80^\circ ext{C}$, forming Type-I (nitric acid trihydrate) and Type-II (water ice) **Polar Stratospheric Clouds (PSCs / Nacreous clouds)**. - Inactive chlorine reservoirs ($HCl$ and $ClONO_2$) react on PSC ice crystal surfaces to release molecular chlorine ($Cl_2$) and $HOCl$. - **Spring (September–October):** Sunlight returns; UV photolyzes $Cl_2$ into free **Chlorine free radicals ($Cl^□ullet$)**. A single chlorine radical can catalytically destroy over **100,000 ozone molecules**: $$Cl^□ullet + O_3 ightarrow ClO^□ullet + O_2$$ $$ClO^□ullet + O ightarrow Cl^□ullet + O_2$$ - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Ozone hole forms primarily over **ANTARCTICA** (South Pole) rather than the Arctic because Antarctica has much colder winter temperatures and a stable, isolated circumpolar vortex!

## Question 382

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Currency Devaluation vs Depreciation

Match List-I (Currency Adjustment) with List-II (Mechanism & Governing Regime) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Term)** A. Currency Devaluation
B. Currency Depreciation
C. Currency Appreciation
D. J-Curve Effect

**List-II (Mechanism & Regime)** 1. Fall in the exchange value of domestic currency determined by market forces of demand and supply in a floating exchange regime
2. Deliberate official downward reduction in the value of domestic currency by the central bank under a fixed exchange rate regime
3. Phenomenon where a currency depreciation worsens the trade balance initially before improving it in the medium term
4. Increase in the external value of domestic currency due to market demand under a floating exchange regime

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Devaluation:** Deliberate governmental reduction of currency value against foreign currencies under a **Fixed / Pegged Exchange Rate** (India devalued the rupee in 1949, 1966, and 1991). - **Depreciation:** Automatic reduction of currency value driven by market forces of demand and supply in a **Floating / Flexible Exchange Rate** system. - **J-Curve Effect:** Following currency depreciation, export volumes take time to expand while import prices rise immediately, so the trade deficit initially widens before reversing into surplus, tracing a 'J' curve. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Devaluation is an OFFICIAL GOVT ACTION under a fixed regime; Depreciation is a MARKET DRIVEN PHENOMENON under a floating regime!

## Question 383

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Prestigious National Honours & Recipient Personalities

Match List-I (Award / Honor 2024) with List-II (Recipient / Work) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Award)** A. 58th Jnanpith Award
B. 33rd Saraswati Samman
C. 33rd Vyas Samman
D. Booker Prize 2024

**List-II (Recipient)** 1. Prabha Varma (*Roudrasathwikam*, Malayalam verse novel)
2. Gulzar (Urdu) and Jagadguru Rambhadracharya (Sanskrit)
3. Samantha Harvey (*Orbital*, UK novel)
4. Pushpa Bharati (*Yaadein, Yaadein aur Yaadein*, Hindi memoir)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **58th Jnanpith Award (for 2023, conferred 2024):** Conferred on **Gulzar** (renowned Urdu lyricist/poet) and **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** (polyglot Sanskrit scholar and spiritual guru). - **33rd Saraswati Samman (KK Birla Foundation):** Malayalam poet **Prabha Varma** for his verse novel *Roudrasathwikam*. - **33rd Vyas Samman (KK Birla Foundation):** Hindi author **Pushpa Bharati** for her nostalgic literary memoir *Yaadein, Yaadein aur Yaadein*. - **Booker Prize 2024:** British novelist **Samantha Harvey** for *Orbital*. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Saraswati Samman covers all 22 languages of the Eighth Schedule; Vyas Samman is awarded ONLY for literary works written in **HINDI**!

---

## Question 384

**Subject:** Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Ashoka's Minor Pillar Inscriptions & Economic Facts

Consider the following statements regarding the Rummindei Pillar Inscription of Ashoka: 1. It is located in the Rupandehi district of Nepal near Lumbini. 2. It conclusively identifies Lumbini as the historical birthplace of the Gautama Buddha (*Hida Budhe Jate Sakyamuniti*). 3. Ashoka exempted the village of Lumbini from religious tax (*Bali*) and reduced the land revenue tax (*Bhaga*) to one-eighth ($\rac{1}{8} \text{th}$).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Rummindei Pillar (Lumbini, Nepal):** Erected in the 20th regnal year of Ashoka (c. 249 BCE) during his imperial pilgrimage with guru Upagupta. - **Inscriptional Text:** States: "*King Devanampiya Piyadasi visited in person and worshipped this stone because the Buddha, the sage of the Sakyas, was born here.*" - **Economic Concession (Only direct Ashokan record on taxation):** - **Bali (religious tribute):** Completely abolished / exempted. - **Bhaga (regular land revenue share):** Reduced from standard $\rac{1}{6} \text{th}$ to **one-eighth ($\rac{1}{8} \text{th}$)** (*Athabhagiya*). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Rummindei is the ONLY Ashokan inscription that explicitly records the **exact rates of Mauryan taxation**!

---

## Question 385

**Subject:** World Geography | **Topic:** World Deserts and Hyper-Arid Basins

Match List-I (Desert) with List-II (Country & Geographical Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Desert)** A. Atacama Desert
B. Dasht-e Kavir
C. Rub' al Khali ("Empty Quarter")
D. Taklamakan Desert

**List-II (Location & Feature)** 1. Arabian Peninsula (Saudi Arabia/UAE); world's largest contiguous sand desert
2. Northern Chile; driest non-polar desert on Earth; rich in sodium nitrate deposits
3. Tarim Basin, Xinjiang (China); cold desert bordered by Tian Shan and Kunlun Mountains
4. Central Iran; great salt desert (*Kavir*) with extensive salt crusts

**Options:** A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Atacama Desert (Chile):** Rainless for decades; weather station at Arica recorded zero rainfall over a 14-year period; major source of iodine, lithium, and sodium nitrates. - **Dasht-e Kavir & Dasht-e Lut:** Deserts of the Iranian plateau; Dasht-e Kavir is a great salt desert; Dasht-e Lut recorded some of the highest land surface temperatures on Earth (~70.7°C). - **Rub' al Khali:** "Empty Quarter"; occupies southern Arabian peninsula; vast shifting sand dunes (*Erg*). - **Taklamakan:** Shifting sand desert in Tarim Basin (China); name means "you enter and you will not exit". - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Largest desert on Earth is **Antarctica** (polar cold desert); largest subtropical hot desert is the **Sahara**!

---

## Question 386

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Attorney General for India (Article 76 & Article 88)

Consider the following statements regarding the Attorney General for India: 1. The Attorney General is appointed by the President and must be a person qualified to be appointed a Judge of the Supreme Court. 2. The Attorney General holds office during the pleasure of the President and receives such remuneration as the President may determine. 3. Under Article 88, the Attorney General has the right to speak and take part in the proceedings of both Houses of Parliament, but does NOT possess the right to vote. 4. The Attorney General is a full-time government servant and is completely debarred from private legal practice.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 3 and 4 only
C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1, 2, and 3 are correct: Article 76 provides for the highest law officer of the country; appointed by the President; holds office during presidential pleasure (no fixed tenure; convention resigns when government resigns). Under **Article 88**, can speak in LS, RS, and joint sittings, and be named a member of any committee, but **CANNOT vote**. - Statement 4 is incorrect: The Attorney General is **NOT a whole-time government servant** (not classified as a civil servant); the AG is **NOT debarred from private legal practice**, provided he does not advise or plead against the Government of India, nor defend accused persons in criminal prosecutions without permission. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Solicitor General of India and Additional Solicitors General are STATUTORY officers, NOT mentioned in the Constitution (Article 76 mentions only the Attorney General)!

---

## Question 387

**Subject:** Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Amir Khusrau's Historical Masnavis

Match List-I (Amir Khusrau's Literary Work) with List-II (Theme / Subject Matter) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Masnavi)** A. Qiran-us-Sadain (1289)
B. Miftah-ul-Futuh (1291)
C. Khazain-ul-Futuh (Tariq-i-Alai)
D. Nuh Sipihr (1318)

**List-II (Theme)** 1. Poetic celebration of India's flora, fauna, climate, sciences, and languages under Mubarak Shah Khalji
2. First historical poem describing the emotional reunion of Sultan Kaiqubad with his father Bughra Khan
3. Military campaigns and victories of Jalaluddin Khalji
4. Detailed prose account of Alauddin Khalji's Deccan campaigns led by Malik Kafur

**Options:** A. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
B. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
C. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Qiran-us-Sadain ("Meeting of Two Auspicious Stars"):** Composed under Kaiqubad; describes the reconciliation between Sultan Kaiqubad and his father Bughra Khan (governor of Bengal) on the banks of Sarayu at Ayodhya. - **Miftah-ul-Futuh ("Key to Victories"):** Chronicles the conquests of Sultan Jalaluddin Khalji. - **Khazain-ul-Futuh:** Sole prose work; official record of Alauddin Khalji's northern conquests and Malik Kafur's southern campaigns (Warangal, Dwarasamudra, Madurai). - **Nuh Sipihr ("Nine Skies"):** Celebrates the superiority of India over all other lands; praises India's peacocks, flowers, chess, mathematics (zero/decimal), and Sanskrit language. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** *Ashiqa* (or *Ishqia*) narrates the tragic romance between Khizr Khan (Alauddin's son) and Deval Devi (princess of Gujarat)!

---

## Question 388

**Subject:** General Science (Chemistry) | **Topic:** Industrial Polymers and Elastomers

Match List-I (Polymer / Plastic) with List-II (Monomer / Chemical Category) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Polymer)** A. Neoprene
B. Buna-S
C. Polystyrene (Thermocol)
D. Melamine

**List-II (Monomer / Composition)** 1. Styrene; packaging material, disposable cups, and thermal insulation
2. Chloroprene (2-chloro-1,3-butadiene); synthetic rubber resistant to oils
3. Copolymer of Melamine and Formaldehyde; unbreakable crockery
4. Copolymer of 1,3-Butadiene and Styrene; automobile tire treads

**Options:** A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Neoprene:** Synthetic rubber formed by polymerization of **Chloroprene**; superior resistance to oils, solvents, and heat; used in gaskets and conveyor belts. - **Buna-S (SBR):** Styrene-Butadiene Rubber; vulcanized with sulfur; major rubber used in motor car tires. - **Polystyrene:** Polymer of styrene ($C_6H_5-CH=CH_2$); blown into expanded foam (*Thermocol*); excellent thermal and acoustic insulator. - **Melamine-Formaldehyde Resin:** Thermosetting plastic polymer; produces hard, shatterproof "unbreakable" dinnerware. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Natural Rubber monomer is **Isoprene** (2-methyl-1,3-butadiene); Synthetic Neoprene monomer is **Chloroprene** (2-chloro-1,3-butadiene)!

---

## Question 389

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Dialects and Classical Literary Giants of UP

Match List-I (Classical Poet / Scholar of UP) with List-II (Primary Literary Dialect / Major Work) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Literary Giant)** A. Goswami Tulsidas
B. Surdas
C. Kabir Das
D. Vidyapati

**List-II (Dialect & Masterpiece)** 1. Braj Bhasha; *Sur Sagar* and *Sur Saravali*
2. Awadhi; *Ramcharitmanas* and *Kavitavali*
3. Maithili; *Padavali* ("Maithil Kokil")
4. Sadhukkadi / Panchmel Khichdi (Bhojpuri-Khari Boli mix); *Bijak*

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Goswami Tulsidas:** Authored *Ramcharitmanas* in **Awadhi**; authored *Vinaya Patrika* and *Kavitavali* in **Braj Bhasha**. - **Surdas:** Blind saint-poet of Braj; disciple of Vallabhacharya; composed *Sur Sagar* in **Braj Bhasha**. - **Kabir Das:** Composed in **Sadhukkadi / Panchmel Khichdi** (blend of Bhojpuri, Awadhi, Rajasthani, and Khari Boli). - **Vidyapati:** Known as

*Maithil Kokil* (Cuckoo of Mithila); composed ecstatic Radha-Krishna lyrics in **Maithili**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Malik Muhammad Jayasi composed the epic *Padmavat* (1540 CE) in **pure Awadhi** during the reign of Sher Shah Suri!

## Question 390

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Hydrarch Ecological Succession

Arrange the seral stages of **Hydrarch Succession** (succession starting in water) in correct chronological order (from pioneer to climax community): 1. Submerged plant stage (e.g. *Hydrilla, Vallisneria*) 2. Phytoplankton stage (pioneer: blue-green algae, diatoms) 3. Reed-swamp stage (e.g. *Typha, Phragmites*) 4. Floating-leaved plant stage (e.g. *Nymphaea, Nelumbo, Eichhornia*) 5. Climax Forest stage

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3 — 5
B. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3 — 5
C. 2 — 4 — 1 — 3 — 5
D. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4 — 5

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Standard stages of Hydrosere (Hydrarch Succession): 1. **Phytoplankton Stage (Pioneer):** Unicellular algae, diatoms, cyanobacteria. 2. **Submerged Plant Stage:** Rooted submerged hydrophytes like *Hydrilla*, *Potamogeton*, *Vallisneria*. 3. **Submerged Free-Floating Stage:** Rooted hydrophytes with floating leaves like *Nelumbo* (Lotus), *Nymphaea*, and free floaters like *Pistia*, *Azolla*. 4. **Reed-Swamp Stage (Amphibious):** *Typha* (cattail), *Phragmites*; plants anchored in silt with shoots exposed to air. 5. **Marsh-Meadow Stage:** Sedges like *Carex*, *Cyperus*. 6. **Scrub / Woodland Stage:** Shrubs like *Salix*, *Cornus*. 7. **Climax Forest Stage:** Mature mesic forest trees (oak, sal, teak). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Both Hydrarch succession (starting in water) and Xerarch succession (starting on dry rock) culminate in the same climax condition: a **MESIC (moderate moisture) community**!

## Question 391

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) and MSF

Consider the following statements regarding the liquidity management framework of the Reserve Bank of India: 1. The Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) serves as the floor of the Liquidity Adjustment Facility (LAF) corridor. 2. The SDF allows the RBI to absorb overnight liquidity from commercial banks without having to pledge government securities as collateral. 3. The Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate serves as the ceiling of the LAF corridor, through which banks can borrow overnight funds against their excess SLR quota.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **LAF Corridor Architecture (Width = 50 bps):** - **Ceiling (Repo Rate + 25 bps): Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)** rate and Bank Rate (overnight penal borrowing window for banks dipping into SLR). - **Center: Policy Repo Rate** (key operational rate). - **Floor (Repo Rate - 25 bps): Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)** (uncollateralized liquidity absorption window introduced in April 2022 under amended Section 17 of RBI Act 1934). - SDF replaced the fixed-rate Reverse Repo as the primary liquidity absorption tool because it does not lock up the RBI's sovereign bond portfolio as collateral! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In the LAF corridor: **MSF is at the TOP (Ceiling), Repo Rate is in the MIDDLE, and SDF is at the BOTTOM (Floor)**!

## Question 392

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Ramsar Wetlands Expansion 2024

In 2024, India's network of Ramsar wetland sites expanded to 85 sites. Which of the following wetlands was added to the Ramsar list in 2024? 1. Nanjarayan Bird Sanctuary (Tamil Nadu) 2. Kazhuveli Bird Sanctuary (Tamil Nadu) 3. Tawa Reservoir (Madhya Pradesh) 4. Magadi Kere Conservation Reserve (Karnataka)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All four sites were designated as Ramsar sites in 2024: - On World Wetlands Day (February 2024), 5 sites were added: **Magadi Kere Conservation Reserve** (Karnataka), **Ankasamudra Bird Conservation Reserve** (Karnataka), **Aghanashini Estuary** (Karnataka), **Karaivetti Bird Sanctuary** (Tamil Nadu), and **Longwood Shola Reserve Forest** (Tamil Nadu). - In August 2024 (ahead of Independence Day), 3 more sites were added: - **Nanjarayan Bird Sanctuary** (Tiruppur district, Tamil Nadu) - **Kazhuveli Bird Sanctuary** (Villupuram district, Tamil Nadu) - **Tawa Reservoir** (Narmadapuram, Madhya Pradesh). - Total Ramsar sites in India reached **85 sites** (Tamil Nadu leads with 16 sites, followed by Uttar Pradesh with 10). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** State with maximum Ramsar sites = **Tamil Nadu (16)**; Second highest = **Uttar Pradesh (10)**!

---

## Question 393

**Subject:** Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Commissions on Education in British India

Match List-I (Educational Commission / Despatch) with List-II (Year & Core Recommendation) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Commission)** A. Charles Wood's Despatch
B. Hunter Commission
C. Saddler University Commission
D. Hartog Committee

**List-II (Year & Recommendation)** 1. 1882; emphasized state responsibility for primary and secondary education; female education
2. 1854; "Magna Carta of English Education in India"; recommended universities at Calcutta, Bombay, Madras
3. 1929; focused on mass education and quality control, warning against hasty expansion of higher education
4. 1917; investigated problems of Calcutta University; recommended 12-year school course (Intermediate)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Wood's Despatch (1854):** Drafted by Sir Charles Wood under Lord Dalhousie; rejected "Downward Filtration Theory"; advocated vernacular primary schools, Anglo-vernacular high schools, grants-in-aid, and universities at Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras (established 1857). - **Hunter Education Commission (1882):** Appointed by Lord Ripon; recommended transfer of primary education management to newly formed district and municipal boards. - **Saddler Commission (1917):** Appointed by Lord Chelmsford; included Indian members Sir Asutosh Mukherjee and Dr. Ziauddin Ahmad; recommended creation of intermediate colleges and separation of secondary from university education. - **Hartog Committee (1929):** Auxiliary committee of Simon Commission; emphasized primary education consolidation to avoid "wastage and stagnation". - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Raleigh Commission (1902) was under Curzon; Saddler Commission (1917) was under Chelmsford; Wardha Scheme (1937) was Mahatma Gandhi's *Nai Talim*!

---

## Question 394

**Subject:** Geography of India | **Topic:** Kaveri River Drainage and Waterfalls

Consider the following statements regarding the Kaveri (Cauvery) River: 1. The Kaveri originates at Talakaveri in the Brahmagiri Range of the Western Ghats in Kodagu (Coorg) district of Karnataka. 2. The river forms two sacred river islands in Karnataka: Srirangapatna and Shivanasamudra. 3. Hemavati, Shimsha, and Arkavathi are major left-bank tributaries, while Kabini, Bhavani, and Amravati are major right-bank tributaries of the Kaveri.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Course & Hydrology:** Length ~800 km; drains parts of Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, and Puducherry. Because its upper catchment receives rainfall from South-West Monsoon (summer) and its lower catchment receives rainfall from North-East Monsoon (winter), the **Kaveri carries water almost throughout the year with**

**less fluctuation than other peninsular rivers**. - **Islands:** Splitting into two branches, it forms 3 sacred islands: **Srirangapatna** and **Shivanasamudra** (in Karnataka), and **Srirangam** (in Tamil Nadu). - **Tributaries:** - *Left Bank:* Harangi, **Hemavati**, Lokapavani, **Shimsha**, **Arkavathi**. - *Right Bank:* Lakshmantirtha, **Kabini**, Suvarnavathi, **Bhavani**, Noyyal, **Amravati**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mettur Dam (Stanley Reservoir) is in Tamil Nadu on the Kaveri; Krishnarajasagara (KRS) Dam is in Karnataka on the Kaveri!

## Question 395

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Administrative Tribunals (Articles 323A and 323B)

Consider the following statements regarding Tribunals in the Indian Constitution: 1. Part XIV-A (Articles 323A and 323B) was added to the Constitution by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976. 2. While Tribunals under Article 323A can be established ONLY by Parliament, Tribunals under Article 323B can be established by BOTH Parliament and State Legislatures. 3. In the L. Chandra Kumar case (1997), the Supreme Court ruled that decisions of Tribunals are subject to the judicial review of the High Court under Articles 226/227.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Added by 42nd CAA 1976:** Based on Swaran Singh Committee recommendations. - **Article 323A vs 323B:** - *Article 323A:* Deals ONLY with public service recruitment and service disputes of civil servants (Central Administrative Tribunal - CAT, set up under Administrative Tribunals Act 1985). Can be enacted **ONLY by Parliament**. - *Article 323B:* Deals with tribunals for other matters (taxation, foreign exchange, industrial disputes, land reforms, food stuffs). Can be established by **BOTH Parliament and State Legislatures** within their legislative competence. - **L. Chandra Kumar (1997):** Struck down clause (2)(d) of Article 323A and 323B that excluded the jurisdiction of High Courts; held that **Judicial Review under Articles 226/227 is an inviolable basic structure of the Constitution**; an aggrieved party must approach the Division Bench of the High Court before appealing to the Supreme Court. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Article 323A can be enacted ONLY by Parliament; Article 323B can be enacted by BOTH Parliament and State Legislatures!

## Question 396

**Subject:** Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** The 16 Hindu Samskaras (Sacraments)

Match List-I (Vedic Samskara) with List-II (Life Stage / Ritual Meaning) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Samskara)** A. Garbhadhana
B. Pumsavana
C. Upanayana
D. Samavartana

**List-II (Ritual & Meaning)** 1. Sacred thread ceremony marking initiation into formal Vedic education; rebirth as *Dvija*
2. Conception ritual performed for invoking divine blessings for childbearing
3. Ritual performed to ensure the birth of a male child and healthy fetus
4. Convocation / graduation ceremony performed on completion of studenthood at Gurukula

**Options:** A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The Grihyasutras systematize **16 Samskaras (Shodasha Samskaras)** governing Hindu life: 1. *Garbhadhana* (Conception) 2. *Pumsavana* (Fetus protection / quickening) 3. *Simantonnayana* (Parting of hair of pregnant mother) 4. *Jatakarma* (Birth ceremony, touching honey and ghee to lips) 5. *Namakarana* (Naming ceremony on 10th/12th day) 6. *Nishkramana* (First outing to see sun) 7. *Annaprashana* (First solid food feeding at 6 months) 8. *Chudakarana / Mundan* (First haircut) 9. *Karnavedha* (Ear piercing) 10. *Vidyarambha* (Learning alphabets) 11. **Upanayana** (Sacred thread *Yajnopavita* initiation into Gayatri mantra; makes one *Dvija* - twice-born) 12. *Vedarambha* (Beginning of Vedic study) 13. *Keshanta / Godana* (First shaving of beard at age 16) 14. **Samavartana** (Graduation bath *Snataka* returning home from Gurukula) 15. *Vivaha* (Marriage - entering Grihastha ashrama) 16. *Antyeshti* (Funeral rites). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Upanayana marks the start of Brahmacharya; Samavartana marks the graduation from Brahmacharya into Grihastha!

## Question 397

**Subject:** General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Archimedes' Principle and Buoyancy

Consider the following statements regarding Archimedes' Principle: 1. Archimedes' Principle states that when a body is immersed fully or partially in a fluid, it experiences an upward buoyant force equal to the weight of the fluid displaced by it. 2. A Hydrometer used to determine the relative density of liquids operates on the principle of floatation derived from Archimedes' Principle. 3. A Lactometer used to determine the purity of milk operates based on Archimedes' Principle.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Archimedes' Principle:** Buoyant Force $F_B = ho_{ ext{fluid}} imes V_{ ext{submerged}} imes g$. - **Law of Floatation:** A floating body displaces fluid whose weight equals the total weight of the body ($W = F_B$). - **Hydrometer & Lactometer:** Both instruments are sealed glass tubes weighted at the bottom; sink deeper in less dense liquids and rise higher in denser liquids; calibrate density based on displaced liquid volume. - **Submarines and Ships:** Iron nail sinks because iron density > water density, but a massive steel ship floats because its hollow hull displaces a volume of water whose weight is far greater than the ship's weight. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** When a floating ice cube in a glass of water melts completely, the **water level in the glass remains UNCHANGED**! (Because the volume of water produced by melting equals the volume of submerged ice).

## Question 398

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Forest Cover Extremes in UP (ISFR Matrix)

Consider the following pairs regarding forest cover in Uttar Pradesh as per ISFR: 1. District with the highest forest area: Sonbhadra (approx. 2,536 sq km) 2. District with the lowest forest area: Bhadohi (Sant Ravidas Nagar, approx. 3.71 sq km) 3. District with the highest percentage of forest cover: Sonbhadra (approx. 35.24%) 4. District with the lowest percentage of forest cover: Bhadohi (approx. 0.37%)

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

**Options:** A. Only two pairs
B. Only three pairs
C. All four pairs
D. Only one pair

**Answer:** C

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All four pairs are perfectly accurate based on the Forest Survey of India (ISFR): - **Maximum Forest Area: Sonbhadra (2,536.40 sq km)**. - **Minimum Forest Area: Bhadohi (3.71 sq km)**. - **Maximum Forest Cover %: Sonbhadra (35.24%)**. - **Minimum Forest Cover %: Bhadohi (0.37%)**. - Sonbhadra is the ONLY district in Uttar Pradesh having more than one-third (33%) of its geographical area under forest cover (meeting the National Forest Policy 1988 target). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Second highest forest percentage in UP is **Chandauli (21.78%)**, followed by **Chitrakoot (19.64%)**!

## Question 399

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Biodiversity Hotspots & Endemism in India

Which of the following endemic mammal species is natively found in the **Western Ghats Biodiversity Hotspot**? 1. Lion-tailed Macaque (*Macaca silenus*) 2. Nilgiri Tahr (*Nilgiritragus hylocrius*) 3. Malabar Civet (*Viverra civettina*)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three mammals are endemic flagship species of the **Western Ghats (Sahyadri)**: - **Lion-tailed Macaque:** Endangered arboreal primate with a silver-white mane; inhabits evergreen rainforest canopies of Silent Valley (Kerala) and Anaimalai. - **Nilgiri Tahr:** Endangered mountain ungulate; state animal of Tamil Nadu; inhabits montane shola grasslands of Eravikulam National Park (Munnar). - **Malabar Civet:** Critically endangered carnivore endemic to the coastal lowland forests of Western Ghats. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Great Indian Bustard is endemic to arid grasslands of **Thar Desert (Rajasthan)**; Sangai (Dancing Deer) is endemic to **Loktak Lake (Manipur)**!

## Question 400

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Tendulkar vs Rangarajan Poverty Metrics

Consider the following statements comparing the Suresh Tendulkar Committee (2009) and C. Rangarajan Committee (2014) on poverty estimation in India: 1. Tendulkar Committee shifted the poverty line away from calorie norms to an explicit consumption basket covering food, education, and health. 2. Tendulkar Committee calculated the all-India poverty ratio at 21.9% for the year 2011–12 (Rs 816 per capita/month rural and Rs 1,000 urban). 3. Rangarajan Committee calculated the all-India poverty ratio at 29.5% for the year 2011–12 (Rs 972 per capita/month rural and Rs 1,407 urban).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Tendulkar Committee (2009):** Used Mixed Reference Period (MRP); estimated poverty line at **₹27.2 per day in rural areas and ₹33.3 per day in urban areas**; gave 2011–12 all-India poverty at **21.92% (approx. 27 crore people)**. - **Rangarajan Committee (2014):** Used Modified Mixed Reference Period (MMRP); accounted for nutritional requirements plus non-food essentials; estimated poverty line at **₹32 per day in rural areas and ₹47 per day in urban areas**; gave 2011–12 all-India poverty at **29.5% (approx. 36.3 crore people)**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Tendulkar poverty line = **21.9%**; Rangarajan poverty line = **29.5%**! (Rangarajan poverty line was significantly higher than Tendulkar).

## Question 401

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Bharat Ratna 2024 Conferments

Match List-I (Bharat Ratna 2024 Recipient) with List-II (Core Field / Historic Contribution) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Recipient)** A. Karpoori Thakur
B. Chaudhary Charan Singh
C. P.V. Narasimha Rao
D. Dr. M.S. Swaminathan

**List-II (Contribution)** 1. Architect of 1991 LPG Economic Reforms; 9th Prime Minister of India
2. Father of India's Green Revolution; renowned agricultural geneticist
3. "Jan Nayak"; socialist pioneer and former Chief Minister of Bihar
4. Champion of Indian farmers; 5th Prime Minister of India; passed UP Zamindari Abolition Act

**Options:** A. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
B. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
C. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
D. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Karpoori Thakur (Posthumous):** "Jan Nayak"; introduced Total Prohibition, promoted vernacular Hindi, and pioneered the 1978 Mungeri Lal Commission formula of backward reservation in Bihar. - **Chaudhary Charan Singh (Posthumous):** Chief Minister of UP (1967, 1970) and 5th PM of India; architect of the historic UP Zamindari Abolition and Land Reforms Act 1950. - **P.V. Narasimha Rao (Posthumous):** Dismantled the License-Permit Raj; appointed Dr. Manmohan Singh as Finance Minister to launch economic liberalization in 1991; initiated "Look East" policy. - **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan (Posthumous):** Collaborated with Norman Borlaug to introduce semi-dwarf high-yielding wheat varieties, saving India from famines; chaired the National Commission on Farmers (recommended MSP at cost C2 + 50%). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** L.K. Advani was the ONLY living recipient among the 5 personalities awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2024!

## Question 402

**Subject:** Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Mughal Revenue Assessment Systems

Match List-I (Mughal Revenue System) with List-II (Mechanism / Distinct Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (System)** A. Zabti / Dahsala System
B. Batai / Ghalla-Bakhshi
C. Kankut System
D. Nasaq System

**List-II (Mechanism)** 1. Rough estimation / summary assessment based on past village revenue payments
2. Actual physical division of harvested crop between the peasant and the State (khet-batai, lang-batai, rasi-batai)
3. Revenue assessment based on land measurement (*Paimaish* by bamboo jarib with iron rings) and average 10-year yield/cash rates
4. Estimation of yield by inspecting standing crop and pacing the fields (*Kan* = estimate, *Kut* = calculate)

**Options:** A. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
B. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
C. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
D. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Zabti (Dahsala, 1580):** Devised by Raja Todar Mal; land measured using *Ilahi Gaz* and *Tanab* (bamboo jarib with iron rings); average yields of preceding 10 years (1570–1580) calculated, State share fixed at $\uparrow$rac{1}{3} ext{rd}$ in cash (*Dastur*). - **Batai / Ghalla-Bakhshi:** Simple crop-sharing; 3 methods: *Khet-batai* (dividing fields after sowing), *Lang-batai* (dividing sheaves after reaping), *Rasi-batai* (dividing grain heaps after threshing). - **Kankut:** Rough ocular estimate of produce based on inspecting standing crop. - **Nasaq:** Quick summary assessment based on previous years' revenue records. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Todar Mal's Bandobast categorized cultivable land into 4 classes: **Polaj** (annually cultivated), **Parauti** (left fallow 1–2 years), **Chachar** (fallow 3–4 years), **Banjar** (uncultivated for 5+ years)!

---

## Question 403

**Subject:** World Geography | **Topic:** Mineral Basins & Mining Districts of Europe

Match List-I (European Mineral Basin) with List-II (Country & Primary Resource) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Basin)** A. Lorraine Basin
B. Upper Silesia
C. Krivoy Rog
D. Saar Basin

**List-II (Country & Mineral)** 1. Poland; major bituminous coal-mining basin
2. France; historic minette iron-ore basin
3. Germany; coalfield along the Saar River on French border
4. Ukraine; vast hematite iron-ore basin near Dnipro river

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Lorraine (France):** Major historic European source of sedimentary *minette* **Iron Ore**; historically contested between France and Germany. - **Upper Silesia (Poland):** Major hard **Coal** mining region fueling Polish metallurgy. - **Krivoy Rog (Kryvyi Rih, Ukraine):** Giant **Iron Ore** basin in central Ukraine supplying Dnipro steel mills. - **Saar Basin (Germany):** Rich **Coalfield** in Saarland along French frontier. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Donbas (Donets Basin) in Ukraine/Russia = **Coal**; Krivoy Rog in Ukraine = **Iron Ore**!

---

## Question 404

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Election Commission Safeguards & Removal

Consider the following statements regarding the Election Commission of India: 1. The Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) can be removed from office ONLY in like manner and on like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court. 2. Any other Election Commissioner or

Regional Commissioner can be removed from office by the President ONLY on the recommendation of the Chief Election Commissioner. 3. The conditions of service and tenure of office of Election Commissioners are determined by Parliament by law.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **CEC Removal (Proviso to Article 324(5)):** Enjoys absolute constitutional security of tenure; can be removed only by parliamentary impeachment (special majority in both Houses on grounds of proved misbehavior or incapacity). - **Other Election Commissioners Removal:** Do not enjoy the same constitutional insulation as the CEC; can be removed by the President **only on the recommendation of the CEC** (established in *T.N. Seshan v. Union of India*, 1995). - **Conditions of Service:** Mandated under Article 324(5) to be determined by Parliament (governed by the Chief Election Commissioner and other ECs Act, 2023). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The CEC CANNOT be removed at the pleasure of the President! But other Election Commissioners can be removed if the CEC formally recommends it.

---

## Question 405

**Subject:** General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Plant Pathologies and Causative Microorganisms

Match List-I (Plant Disease) with List-II (Causative Pathogen & Crop) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Disease)** A. Citrus Canker
B. Late Blight of Potato
C. Black Rust of Wheat
D. Red Rot of Sugarcane

**List-II (Pathogen & Crop)** 1. *Phytophthora infestans* (Fungus); causes rot of potato tubers (triggered Irish Famine 1845)
2. *Xanthomonas axonopodis* (Bacterium); lesions on citrus leaves, twigs, and fruits
3. *Colletotrichum falcatum* (Fungus); red discoloration of pith and alcoholic odor in sugarcane
4. *Puccinia graminis tritici* (Fungus); brown/black pustules on wheat stems

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Citrus Canker:** Caused by **bacterium** *Xanthomonas*; transmitted by wind and rain splash; affects acid lime and sweet oranges. - **Late Blight of Potato:** Caused by **fungus-like oomycete** *Phytophthora infestans*; wiped out the Irish potato crop in 1845 causing the catastrophic Great Irish Famine. - **Black Rust of Wheat:** Caused by heteroecious **rust fungus** *Puccinia graminis*; alternate host is the Barberry plant (*Berberis*). Prof. K.C. Mehta of Agra College discovered the annual recurrence cycle of rust in India. - **Red Rot of Sugarcane:** Caused by **fungus** *Colletotrichum falcatum*; vascular bundles turn red with white cross-bands, smelling of sour alcohol. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Citrus Canker is **BACTERIAL**; Late Blight, Black Rust, and Red Rot are **FUNGAL**!

---

## Question 406

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Mineral Wealth & Specific Deposits of UP

Which of the following minerals is found in **Lalitpur** district of Uttar Pradesh? 1. Uranium 2. Copper 3. Platinum Group Minerals (in Madawara area)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Lalitpur district in the Bundelkhand region is the most mineral-rich district of Uttar Pradesh: - **Uranium:** Confirmed small occurrences in Lalitpur. - **Copper:** Mined in the **Sonrai area of Lalitpur**. - **Platinum Group Elements (PGE)**

**/ Gold:** Traces found in the **Madawara ultrabasic complex** in Lalitpur. - **Diaspore & Pyrophyllite:** Extensively quarried. - **Iron Ore:** Banded Iron Formations occur in Solda (Lalitpur). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Lalitpur is UP's ONLY district with known reserves of Uranium and Copper!

## Question 407

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Kyoto Protocol Greenhouse Gases

Which of the following greenhouse gases was NOT among the original six greenhouse gases targeted under the Kyoto Protocol (1997)?

**Options:** A. Carbon Dioxide ($CO_2$)
B. Methane ($CH_4$)
C. Chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs)
D. Sulphur Hexafluoride ($SF_6$)

**Answer:** C

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The 6 original greenhouse gases controlled under **Annex A of the Kyoto Protocol** (1997) were: 1. Carbon Dioxide ($CO_2$) 2. Methane ($CH_4$) 3. Nitrous Oxide ($N_2O$) 4. Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs) 5. Perfluorocarbons (PFCs) 6. Sulphur Hexafluoride ($SF_6$) - **Chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs)** were NOT included in the Kyoto Protocol because they were already regulated and being phased out under the **Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer (1987)**! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Classic UPPSC trap: CFCs are Ozone-Depleting Substances regulated by the Montreal Protocol, NOT the Kyoto Protocol!

## Question 408

**Subject:** Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Landmark Congress Presidents & Milestones

Match List-I (INC Annual Session) with List-II (President & Landmark Decision) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Session)** A. 1885 Bombay Session
B. 1924 Belgaum Session
C. 1931 Karachi Session
D. 1938 Haripura Session

**List-II (President & Landmark)** 1. Mahatma Gandhi; ONLY Congress session ever presided over by Gandhi
2. W.C. Bonnerjee; Inaugural session attended by 72 delegates at Gokuldas Tejpal College
3. Subhas Chandra Bose; National Planning Committee set up under Jawaharlal Nehru
4. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel; Resolution on Fundamental Rights and National Economic Programme passed

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **1885 Bombay:** W.C. Bonnerjee presided; 72 delegates; founded by retired ICS officer A.O. Hume. - **1924 Belgaum (Karnataka): Mahatma Gandhi's sole presidency**; endorsed the Gandhi-Das pact; worked for Hindu-Muslim unity and untouchability removal. - **1931 Karachi:** Vallabhbhai Patel presided; ratified the Gandhi-Irwin Pact; passed historic **Resolution on Fundamental Rights and National Economic Programme** (drafted by Nehru). - **1938 Haripura (Gujarat):** Subhas Chandra Bose presided; constituted the **National Planning Committee** with Jawaharlal Nehru as its Chairman. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In 1939 Tripuri session, Subhas Bose defeated Gandhi's candidate Pattabhi Sitaramayya, but resigned due to differences over the Pant Resolution!

## Question 409

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Current Account vs Capital Account Items

Which of the following items is recorded under the **CAPITAL ACCOUNT** of India's Balance of Payments (BoP)? 1. External Commercial Borrowings (ECB) 2. Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) equity inflows 3. Non-Resident Indian (NRI) bank deposits 4. Inward remittances from Indian workers in Gulf countries

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Capital Account Items (Items creating or liquidating foreign assets and liabilities):** - **FDI and FPI** (equity and debt) - **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)** and external sovereign debt - **NRI Deposits** (FCNR, NRE accounts held in Indian banks) - Banking capital and short-term trade credits. - **Current Account Items (Items affecting current output/income, without creating claims on future assets):** - Merchandise trade (exports and imports of goods) - Invisibles (software services, transportation, travel) - **Unilateral Transfers / Inward Remittances** (remittances sent home by NRIs in Gulf/USA are private transfers in the Current Account!). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Remittances sent by Indian workers abroad are recorded in the **CURRENT ACCOUNT** (under Invisibles / Transfers), NOT the Capital Account!

---

## Question 410

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Manu Bhaker's Historic Double Bronze at Paris 2024

Consider the following statements regarding shooter Manu Bhaker at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games: 1. She won the Bronze medal in the Women's 10m Air Pistol individual event. 2. She won another Bronze medal in the 10m Air Pistol Mixed Team event partnering Sarabjot Singh. 3. She became the first athlete from independent India to win two medals at the same Olympic Games.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - 22-year-old **Manu Bhaker** (from Jhajjar, Haryana) scripted Indian Olympic history in Paris: - Opened India's medal account by winning Bronze in **Women's 10m Air Pistol** on July 28, 2024 (first Indian woman shooter ever to win an Olympic medal). - Won her second Bronze in **10m Air Pistol Mixed Team** on July 30, 2024, alongside **Sarabjot Singh**. - In pre-independence India, Norman Pritchard had won two silver medals in athletics in Paris 1900; Manu Bhaker is the **first athlete representing independent India** to achieve this milestone. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** She finished 4th in her third event (Women's 25m Pistol), narrowly missing a historic third medal!

---

## Question 411

**Subject:** Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Harappan Ports and Coastal Entrepots

Match List-I (Harappan Coastal Site) with List-II (State / Region & Distinct Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Site)** A. Lothal
B. Suktagendor
C. Malwan
D. Balakot

**List-II (Location & Significance)** 1. Southernmost coastal Harappan site in Surat district, Gujarat (Tapti estuary)
2. Lasbela coast, Pakistan; specialized center for sea-shell bangle and bead manufacturing
3. Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat; world's earliest known tidal dockyard connected to Bhogava river
4. Makran coast, Baluchistan (near Iran border); westernmost outpost of the Harappan civilization

**Options:** A. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
B. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
C. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
D. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Lothal (Gujarat):** Premier port and dockyard of Harappan civilization; engaged in maritime trade with Dilmun (Bahrain) and Magan (Oman). - **Suktagendor (Baluchistan):** Westernmost extremity of the Harappan world, situated on the Dasht river; fortified coastal trading outpost. - **Malwan (Gujarat):** Located near the mouth of Tapti river; southernmost mature Harappan site in Gujarat. - **Balakot (Pakistan):** Located on Sonmiani Bay; major sea-shell harvesting and craft manufacturing hub (*Turbinella pyrum*). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Easternmost Harappan site = **Alamgirpur (Hindon river, Meerut, UP)**; Westernmost = **Suktagendor (Dasht river, Baluchistan)**; Northernmost = **Manda (Chenab river, J&K)**; Southernmost = **Daimabad (Pravara river, Maharashtra)**!

## Question 412

**Subject:** World Geography | **Topic:** African Great Lakes and the Equator

Through which of the following Great Lakes of Africa does the **Equator ($0^\circ$)** pass directly?

**Options:** A. Lake Tanganyika
B. Lake Victoria
C. Lake Malawi (Nyasa)
D. Lake Chad

**Answer:** B

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Lake Victoria:** - Largest lake in Africa and second largest freshwater lake in the world by surface area (~68,800 sq km). - **The Equator passes directly across the northern section of Lake Victoria**. - Bordered by 3 nations: **Uganda, Kenya, and Tanzania**. - Chief reservoir of the White Nile river. - **Lake Tanganyika:** Longest freshwater lake in the world (~673 km) and second deepest (~1,470 m); lies entirely in the Southern Hemisphere (south of Equator). - **Lake Malawi (Nyasa):** Located south of Tanganyika in the East African Rift Valley. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Lake Victoria is NOT situated in the rift valley trench itself, but occupies a shallow tectonic depression between the Eastern and Western rift branches!

## Question 413

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Preamble Dates and Concepts

Consider the following statements regarding the Preamble of the Indian Constitution: 1. The date of adoption of the Constitution mentioned in the Preamble is "the twenty-sixth day of November, 1949". 2. The ideals of 'Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity' in our Preamble were inspired by the French Revolution (1789). 3. The ideal of 'Justice — social, economic, and political' was inspired by the Russian Revolution (1917).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Date:** Concludes: "*In our Constituent Assembly this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do hereby Adopt, Enact and Give to ourselves this Constitution.*" (Certain provisions like citizenship, elections, provisional parliament came into force on 26 Nov 1949; the full Constitution took effect on **26 January 1950** to commemorate Purna Swaraj Day 1930). - **Inspirations:** - **Justice (Social, Economic, Political):** Drawn from the **1917 Russian Revolution**. - **Liberty, Equality, Fraternity:** Drawn from the **1789 French Revolution**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Preamble has been amended **ONLY ONCE** in history: by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976!

## Question 414

**Subject:** General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Thermodynamics of Everyday Thermal Phenomena

Match List-I (Thermal Phenomenon) with List-II (Physical Principle Involved) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Phenomenon)** A. Cooling produced in an earthen pitcher (*Surahi / Matka*)
B. Severe burns caused by steam compared to boiling water at 100°C
C. Bursting of water pipes in sub-zero winter temperatures
D. Quicker cooking of food in a pressure cooker

**List-II (Principle)** 1. Anomalous volume expansion of water upon freezing from 4°C to 0°C
2. Latent heat of vaporization ($~540 ext{ cal/g}$)
3. Cooling caused by continuous evaporation through microscopic clay pores
4. Elevated boiling point of water under increased chamber pressure ($> 100^\circ ext{C}$)

**Options:** A. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
B. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
C. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4
D. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Matka Cooling:** Water seeps through unglazed pores; evaporates by taking latent heat of vaporization from the remaining water, cooling it down. - **Steam Burns:** Steam at 100°C contains an extra $2.26 imes 10^6 ext{ J/kg}$ of latent heat compared to water at 100°C. - **Bursting Pipes:** Water expands by ~9% upon freezing into ice; in enclosed pipes, this expansion exerts immense hydrostatic pressure. - **Pressure Cooker:** Increases internal pressure to ~2 atmospheres, raising the boiling point of water from 100°C to **~120°C**, allowing food to cook much faster. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** At high altitudes (mountains), atmospheric pressure is low, so water boils at LESS than 100°C, making cooking slower!

## Question 415

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** States Bordering Uttar Pradesh Districts

Match List-I (Bordering State) with List-II (UP District Bordering It) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (State)** A. Himachal Pradesh
B. Chhattisgarh
C. Jharkhand
D. Rajasthan

**List-II (Bordering UP District)** 1. Sonbhadra exclusively (Southern boundary)
2. Saharanpur exclusively (Shortest state border of UP)
3. Agra and Mathura
4. Sonbhadra exclusively (Southeastern boundary)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Himachal Pradesh:** Shares UP's shortest state boundary; touches ONLY **Saharanpur** district. - **Chhattisgarh:** Touches ONLY **Sonbhadra** district (to the south). - **Jharkhand:** Touches ONLY **Sonbhadra** district (to the south-east). - **Rajasthan:** Touches 2 UP districts: **Agra and Mathura**. - **Madhya Pradesh:** Shares UP's **longest state boundary**; touches 11 UP districts (Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra). - **Bihar:** Touches 7 UP districts (Sonbhadra, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Ballia, Deoria, Kushi Nagar, Maharajganj). - **Uttarakhand:** Touches 7 UP districts (Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Moradabad, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UP shares its longest boundary with **Madhya Pradesh**, and shortest boundary with **Himachal Pradesh**!

## Question 416

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972 Historic Roots

Consider the following statements regarding the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: 1. It was enacted under Article 252 of the Constitution after several State Legislatures passed resolutions authorizing Parliament to legislate on wildlife. 2. Prior to the 42nd Amendment Act 1976, 'Wild animals and birds' was an exclusive subject under the State List (List II). 3. The National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) is a statutory body constituted under Section 5A of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, chaired by the Prime Minister.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - Enacted in September 1972 under Article 252 (because 11 state assemblies passed authorizing resolutions; prior to 1976, wildlife was Entry 20 of State List). - The 42nd Amendment Act 1976 shifted it to the **Concurrent List (Entry 17B)**. - **NBWL (Section 5A):** Apex statutory body for wildlife policy; **chaired by the Prime Minister of India** (Union Environment Minister is Vice-Chairman). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** National Board for Wildlife is chaired by the **PRIME MINISTER**, NOT the Environment Minister!

## Question 417

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** CPI Inflation Weights Breakdown

In the Consumer Price Index for Combined (CPI-C, Base 2012) published by NSO, arrange the following commodity groups in descending order of their assigned weightage: 1. Food and Beverages 2. Housing 3. Fuel and Light 4. Pan, tobacco and intoxicants

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

**Options:** A. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
B. 1 — 3 — 2 — 4
C. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Weights in CPI (Combined Base 2012 = 100): 1. **Food and Beverages: 45.86%** (Cereals 9.67%, Milk 6.61%, Vegetables 6.04%). 2. **Miscellaneous (Services): 28.32%** (Transport, Health, Education). 3. **Housing: 10.07%** (applies only to urban CPI). 4. **Fuel and Light: 6.84%** (LPG, electricity, kerosene). 5. **Clothing and Footwear: 6.53%**. 6. **Pan, tobacco and intoxicants: 2.38%**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Food and Beverages has the LARGEST weight in CPI (~45.86%); Housing has ~10.07%; Fuel & Light has ~6.84%!

---

## Question 418

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Multilateral Diplomacy (SCO & Belarus)

Which country became the newest (10th) permanent member of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) during the 2024 Summit held in Astana?

**Options:** A. Belarus
B. Iran
C. Mongolia
D. Turkey

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Belarus** was officially admitted as the 10th full member state of the SCO at the Astana Summit in Kazakhstan on July 4, 2024. - Chronology of SCO membership: - 2001 (Founding 6): China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan. - 2017 (Astana Summit): **India and Pakistan** admitted as full members. - 2023 (New Delhi Summit): **Iran** admitted as 9th member. - 2024 (Astana Summit): **Belarus** admitted as 10th member. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Iran was inducted in 2023 (under India's presidency); Belarus was inducted in **2024**!

---

## Question 419

**Subject:** Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Central Administrative Officers of the Mughal Court

Match List-I (Mughal Central Officer) with List-II (Portfolio / Official Function) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Officer)** A. Mir Bakshi
B. Mir Saman (Khan-i-Saman)
C. Sadr-us-Sudur
D. Muhtasib

**List-II (Function)** 1. In-charge of the imperial household, royal workshops (*Karkhanas*), and internal palace supplies
2. Head of the military department; issued *Sarkhat* (pay warrants); verified mansabdars' horses and descriptive rolls
3. Public censor of morals; enforced Islamic code, proper weights/measures, and prevented open drinking
4. Chief advisor on religious matters; in-charge of royal judicial endowments and charity (*Madad-i-Maash*)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Mir Bakshi:** Supreme head of the military establishment; inspected cavalry contingents (*Dagh-o-Chehra*); presented candidates for imperial mansabs to the emperor; signed pay certificates (*Sarkhat*). - **Mir Saman:** Controlled the imperial *Karkhanas* (royal manufacturing factories), palace stores, and royal kitchen. - **Sadr-us-Sudur:** Guardian of Islamic jurisprudence;

administered religious land grants (*Suyurghal*); often held concurrent post of *Qazi-ul-Quzat* (Chief Justice). - **Muhtasib:** Censor of public morals; appointed to ensure public decorum, gambling prevention, and correct weights in bazaars. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mir Bakshi was NOT the commander-in-chief of the army! The **Emperor himself was the Supreme Commander**; the Mir Bakshi was the head of the military administrative department.

## Question 420

**Subject:** Geography of India | **Topic:** Mountain Passes of India Master Match

Match List-I (Mountain Pass) with List-II (State / UT) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Pass)** A. Shipki La
B. Lipulekh
C. Nathu La
D. Bomdila

**List-II (State / UT)** 1. Uttarakhand (Pithoragarh)
2. Himachal Pradesh (Kinnaur)
3. Arunachal Pradesh
4. Sikkim

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Shipki La:** Himachal Pradesh (Kinnaur); Sutlej gorge entry point from Tibet. - **Lipulekh:** Uttarakhand (Pithoragarh); tri-junction of India, Tibet, Nepal; Kailash Mansarovar pilgrimage route. - **Nathu La:** Sikkim; historic Silk Route branch into Chumbi Valley. - **Bomdila:** Arunachal Pradesh; leads to Tawang monastery. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Lipulekh is in Uttarakhand; Shipki La is in Himachal Pradesh!

## Question 421

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Directive Principles Classification

Match List-I (Constitutional DPSP Article) with List-II (Classification Category) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Article)** A. Article 40 (Village Panchayats)
B. Article 44 (Uniform Civil Code)
C. Article 39A (Equal justice and free legal aid)
D. Article 47 (Prohibition of intoxicating drinks)

**List-II (Ideological Classification)** 1. Liberal-Intellectual Principle
2. Gandhian Principle
3. Socialistic Principle
4. Gandhian Principle

*Note: Match carefully knowing Article 40 and 47 are Gandhian.*

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (or A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2)
B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Socialistic Principles:** Articles 38, 39, **39A**, 41, 42, 43, 43A. - **Gandhian Principles: Article 40** (Panchayats), Article 43 (cottage industries), Article 43B (cooperatives), Article 46 (SC/ST welfare), **Article 47** (prohibition of liquor and drugs), Article 48 (prohibition of slaughter of cows/calves). - **Liberal-Intellectual Principles: Article 44** (Uniform Civil Code), Article 45 (early childhood care), Article 48 (modern agriculture), Article 48A (environment/wildlife), Article 50 (separation of judiciary), Article 51 (international peace). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Article 40, 43, 43B, 46, 47, and 48 are Gandhian; Article 44, 45, 48, 48A, 50, and 51 are Liberal-Intellectual!

## Question 422

**Subject:** General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Vaccines and Immunization

Match List-I (Vaccine) with List-II (Disease Protected Against) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Vaccine)** A. BCG (Bacillus Calmette-Guérin)
B. Salk / Sabin Vaccine
C. MMR Vaccine
D. TAB Vaccine

**List-II (Disease)** 1. Poliomyelitis (Polio)
2. Tuberculosis (TB)
3. Typhoid fever
4. Measles, Mumps, and Rubella

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **BCG:** Live attenuated strain of *Mycobacterium bovis*; developed by Albert Calmette and Camille Guérin in 1921; given intradermally to neonates to protect against **Tuberculosis**. - **Polio Vaccines:** - Jonas Salk (1955): Inactivated Polio Vaccine (IPV - injectable). - Albert Sabin (1961): Oral Polio Vaccine (OPV - live attenuated drops). - **MMR:** Protects against **Measles, Mumps, and Rubella** (German measles). - **TAB:** Vaccine protecting against **Typhoid and Paratyphoid A & B**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** DPT vaccine is a triple antigen protecting against **Diphtheria, Pertussis (Whooping Cough), and Tetanus**!

---

## Question 423

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Famous Fairs of UP Final Review

Match List-I (Fair in UP) with List-II (District) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Fair)** A. Bateshwar Fair
B. Nauchandi Fair
C. Shakumbhari Devi Fair
D. Dadri Fair

**List-II (District)** 1. Meerut
2. Agra
3. Ballia
4. Saharanpur

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bateshwar Fair:** Agra (Yamuna bank; camel/cattle fair). - **Nauchandi Fair:** Meerut (communal harmony). - **Shakumbhari Devi Fair:** Saharanpur (Shivalik foothills). - **Dadri Fair:** Ballia (cattle fair). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Bateshwar = Agra; Nauchandi = Meerut; Shakumbhari = Saharanpur; Dadri = Ballia!

---

## Question 424

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ecological Pyramids Master Summary

Which of the following ecological pyramids is **NEVER INVERTED** in any natural ecosystem?

**Options:** A. Pyramid of Numbers
B. Pyramid of Biomass
C. Pyramid of Energy
D. Both Pyramid of Numbers and Biomass

**Answer:** C

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Pyramid of Energy:** ALWAYS upright, without exception. In accordance with the Second Law of Thermodynamics and Lindeman's 10% law, energy is dissipated as heat at every trophic level. - **Pyramid of Biomass:** Can be inverted in aquatic ecosystems (standing crop of phytoplankton is small compared to long-lived zooplankton and fish). - **Pyramid of Numbers:** Can be inverted in parasite food chains or a single tree ecosystem supporting thousands of insects and hyperparasites. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Only the **Pyramid of Energy** is 100% strictly upright across all biomes on Earth!

---

## Question 425

**Subject:** Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Revolt of 1857 Leaders & Suppressors

Match List-I (Center of 1857 Revolt) with List-II (British Officer Who Suppressed It) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Center)** A. Delhi
B. Kanpur
C. Jhansi
D. Lucknow

**List-II (British Officer)** 1. Sir Hugh Rose
2. John Nicholson and Lieutenant Hudson
3. Sir Colin Campbell
4. Sir Colin Campbell

*Note: Kanpur and Lucknow both saw Colin Campbell's victorious relief campaigns.*

**Options:** A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 (or A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3)
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Delhi:** John Nicholson stormed Delhi in September 1857 (Nicholson was mortally wounded); Hudson arrested Bahadur Shah Zafar at Humayun's Tomb and shot his sons. - **Kanpur:** Recaptured by **Sir Colin Campbell** in December 1857; Nana Saheb escaped to Nepal; Tatya Tope joined Rani Lakshmibai. - **Jhansi:** Suppressed by **Sir Hugh Rose** (who famously eulogized Rani Lakshmibai: "*Here lay the woman who was the only man among the rebels*"). - **Lucknow:** Relieved and recaptured by **Sir Colin Campbell** and Outram in March 1858; Begum Hazrat Mahal took asylum in Nepal. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Colin Campbell suppressed both **Kanpur and Lucknow**! Hugh Rose captured **Jhansi and Gwalior**.

---

## Question 426

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Quantitative Tools of the Reserve Bank of India

Match List-I (Monetary Policy Tool) with List-II (Operational Definition) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Tool)** A. Repo Rate
B. Reverse Repo Rate
C. Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)
D. Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)

**List-II (Definition)** 1. Percentage of Net Demand and Time Liabilities (NDTL) that banks must keep with RBI in cash
2. Rate at which RBI lends short-term funds to commercial banks against government securities
3. Percentage of NDTL that commercial banks must maintain in liquid assets (cash, gold, approved G-Secs)
4. Rate at which RBI borrows funds from commercial banks

**Options:** A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Repo Rate (Repurchase Option):** Central policy rate; commercial banks pledge government securities to borrow cash from RBI. - **Reverse Repo:** Rate at which banks deposit funds with RBI. - **CRR:** Mandated under Section 42 of RBI Act 1934; maintained in pure cash with RBI (earns zero interest). - **SLR:** Mandated under Section 24 of Banking Regulation Act 1949; held by banks themselves in liquid unencumbered assets. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Repo = RBI lends to banks; Reverse Repo = RBI borrows from banks!

---

## Question 427

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2024

The discovery of **microRNA** and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation earned the 2024 Nobel Prize in Medicine for which two scientists?

**Options:** A. Victor Ambros and Gary Ruvkun
B. Katalin Kariko and Drew Weissman
C. Svante Paabo and David Julius
D. Emmanuelle Charpentier and Jennifer Doudna

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Awarded to American scientists **Victor Ambros** (UMass Chan Medical School) and **Gary Ruvkun** (Harvard Medical School). - Discovered that tiny molecules of microRNA ($miRNA$) act as fundamental switches that govern gene expression in multicellular organisms. - Katalin Kariko and Drew Weissman won in 2023 for nucleoside base modifications enabling mRNA COVID-19 vaccines. - Svante Paabo won in 2022 for genomes of extinct hominins. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** MicroRNA regulates gene expression at the POST-TRANSCRIPTIONAL stage (binding to mRNA)!

---

## Question 428

**Subject:** Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Ashoka's Edicts Final Review

Match List-I (Ashokan Major Rock Edict) with List-II (Core Theme) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Edict)** A. Major Rock Edict XIII
B. Major Rock Edict II
C. Major Rock Edict XII
D. Major Rock Edict I

**List-II (Theme)** 1. Medical treatment for humans and animals; mentions southern kingdoms (Chola, Pandya)
2. Kalinga war conquest by Dhamma; mentions five contemporary Greek rulers
3. Prohibition of animal sacrifice and festive gatherings
4. Promotion of religious harmony and growth of the essence of all religions

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **MRE XIII:** Kalinga War (261 BCE); Dhamma victory over Antiochus, Ptolemy, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander. - **MRE II:** Medical care for men and beasts; mentions Cholas, Pandyas, Satyaputra, Keralaputra. - **MRE XII:** Religious tolerance and concord (*Samavaya*). - **MRE I:** Prohibition of animal slaughter in royal kitchen and sacrificial rituals. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Ashoka's Greek and Aramaic bilingual edict was discovered at **Kandahar (Shar-i-Kuna, Afghanistan)**!

---

## Question 429

**Subject:** World Geography | **Topic:** Strategic Water Chokepoints

Match List-I (Global Strait) with List-II (Connecting Waters) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Strait)** A. Strait of Hormuz
B. Bab-el-Mandeb
C. Strait of Malacca
D. Strait of Gibraltar

**List-II (Waters Connected)** 1. Red Sea and Gulf of Aden
2. Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman
3. Mediterranean Sea and Atlantic Ocean
4. Andaman Sea and South China Sea

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Hormuz:** Persian Gulf $\leftrightarrow$ Gulf of Oman (oil chokepoint). - **Bab-el-Mandeb:** Red Sea $\leftrightarrow$ Gulf of Aden ("Gate of Tears"). - **Malacca:** Andaman Sea $\leftrightarrow$ South China Sea. - **Gibraltar:** Atlantic Ocean $\leftrightarrow$ Mediterranean Sea. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Hormuz links Persian Gulf to Gulf of Oman; Bab-el-Mandeb links Red Sea to Gulf of Aden!

---

## Question 430

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Rajya Sabha Exclusive Federal Powers

Under the Indian Constitution, the Rajya Sabha possesses exclusive powers to: 1. Pass a resolution authorizing Parliament to make a law on a State List subject in national interest (Article 249). 2. Pass a resolution authorizing Parliament to create one or more new All-India Services (Article 312). 3. Originate a resolution for the removal of the Vice-President of India (Article 67(b)).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three are exclusive constitutional prerogatives of the Rajya Sabha: - **Article 249:** 2/3rd majority of members present and voting allows Parliament to legislate on State List (valid 1 year). - **Article 312:** 2/3rd majority of members present and voting allows Parliament to create new All-India Services (like IAS, IPS, IFS). - **Article 67(b):** Vice-President removal can originate ONLY in Rajya Sabha (passed by effective majority and agreed to by Lok Sabha). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Indian Forest Service (IFS) was created as the 3rd All-India Service in **1966** under Article 312!

---

## Question 431

**Subject:** General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Daily Optical Phenomena

Match List-I (Optical Phenomenon) with List-II (Core Physics Principle) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Phenomenon)** A. Mirage in hot deserts
B. Blue appearance of the clear sky
C. Primary Rainbow
D. Colors in soap bubbles

**List-II (Principle)** 1. Rayleigh Scattering of light inversely proportional to $\lambda^4$
2. Total Internal Reflection (TIR)
3. Interference of light waves in thin films
4. Dispersion, Refraction, and Internal Reflection in water droplets

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Mirage:** Total Internal Reflection. - **Blue Sky:** Rayleigh Scattering ($\propto \frac{1}{\lambda^4}$). - **Rainbow:** Dispersion, Refraction, and Internal Reflection. - **Soap Bubble Colors:** Thin Film Interference. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Blue sky is Scattering; Rainbow is Dispersion/Refraction; Soap bubble is Interference!

---

## Question 432

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** UP ODOP Core Pairs

Match List-I (UP District) with List-II (ODOP Product) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (District)** A. Bhadohi
B. Kannauj
C. Firozabad
D. Siddharthnagar

**List-II (Product)** 1. Glassware and Bangles
2. Handmade Carpets (Dhurries)
3. Kalanamak Scented Rice
4. Attar (Perfume) and Essential Oils

**Options:** A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Bhadohi = Carpets; Kannauj = Attar; Firozabad = Glass bangles; Siddharthnagar = Kalanamak rice. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Bhadohi = Carpet; Kannauj = Perfume; Firozabad = Bangles; Siddharthnagar = Kalanamak rice!

## Question 433

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) Master Match

Match List-I (SDG Number) with List-II (Official Goal Title) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Goal)** A. SDG 1
B. SDG 2
C. SDG 5
D. SDG 13

**List-II (Title)** 1. Zero Hunger
2. No Poverty
3. Climate Action
4. Gender Equality

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - SDG 1 = No Poverty; SDG 2 = Zero Hunger; SDG 5 = Gender Equality; SDG 13 = Climate Action. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** SDG 3 = Good Health; SDG 4 = Quality Education; SDG 6 = Clean Water; SDG 7 = Clean Energy!

## Question 434

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Types of Unemployment Definitions

Match List-I (Unemployment Type) with List-II (Core Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Type)** A. Disguised Unemployment
B. Structural Unemployment
C. Frictional Unemployment
D. Cyclical Unemployment

**List-II (Feature)** 1. Mismatch between job requirements and workers' skill sets due to structural technological change
2. Marginal physical productivity of labor is zero; common in Indian agriculture
3. Results from periodic trade cycles and macro-economic demand recessions
4. Temporary phase while a person is searching for a job or transitioning between jobs

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Disguised = Marginal productivity zero (Agriculture); Structural = Skill mismatch; Frictional = Search time; Cyclical = Demand slump. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In agriculture, withdrawing workers without reducing output is the hallmark of **Disguised Unemployment**!

---

## Question 435

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** BRICS Expansion 2024

On January 1, 2024, which four nations officially joined the BRICS grouping as full permanent members?

**Options:** A. Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE
B. Argentina, Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Indonesia
C. Nigeria, Kenya, Pakistan, and Mexico
D. Egypt, Qatar, South Africa, and Brazil

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The 4 confirmed new full members inducted on January 1, 2024, were: **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)**. - Argentina withdrew; Saudi Arabia is an invited participant. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE are the 4 confirmed new members!

---

## Question 436

**Subject:** Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Bhakti Philosophies Master Review

Match List-I (Bhakti Philosopher) with List-II (Vedantic Doctrine) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Acharya)** A. Shankaracharya
B. Ramanujacharya
C. Madhvacharya
D. Vallabhacharya

**List-II (Doctrine)** 1. Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-Dualism)
2. Advaita (Absolute Non-Dualism)
3. Shuddhadvaita (Pure Non-Dualism / Pushtimarg)
4. Dvaita (Strict Dualism)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Shankara = Advaita; Ramanuja = Vishishtadvaita; Madhva = Dvaita; Vallabha = Shuddhadvaita; Nimbarka = Dvaitadvaita. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Vallabhacharya propounded Shuddhadvaita (Pushtimarg); Nimbarka propounded Dvaitadvaita (Bhedabheda)!

---

## Question 437

**Subject:** Geography of India | **Topic:** Highest Mountain Peaks of India

Match List-I (Mountain System) with List-II (Highest Peak) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Range)** A. Aravalli Range
B. Satpura Range
C. Western Ghats / South India
D. Nilgiri Hills

**List-II (Highest Peak)** 1. Dhupgarh (1,350 m)
2. Guru Shikhar (1,722 m)
3. Dodabetta (2,637 m)
4. Anaimudi (2,695 m)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Aravalli = Guru Shikhar (Mt Abu); Satpura = Dhupgarh (Pachmarhi); Western Ghats & South India = Anaimudi (Anaimalai hills); Nilgiris = Dodabetta. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Anaimudi is the HIGHEST peak in all of South India!

---

## Question 438

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Constitutional Schedules Master Match

Match List-I (Schedule) with List-II (Core Subject) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Schedule)** A. Fourth Schedule
B. Seventh Schedule
C. Eighth Schedule
D. Tenth Schedule

**List-II (Subject)** 1. Three Legislative Lists (Union, State, Concurrent)
2. Allocation of seats in Rajya Sabha to States/UTs
3. Anti-Defection Law
4. 22 Languages recognized by Constitution

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - 4th = Rajya Sabha seats; 7th = 3 Lists; 8th = 22 Languages; 10th = Anti-defection (52nd CAA). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 11th Schedule has 29 items (Panchayats); 12th Schedule has 18 items (Municipalities)!

---

## Question 439

**Subject:** General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Vitamin Deficiencies Quick Recall

Match List-I (Vitamin) with List-II (Deficiency Disease / Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Vitamin)** A. Vitamin B1 (Thiamine)
B. Vitamin B3 (Niacin)
C. Vitamin B12 (Cyanocobalamin)
D. Vitamin D (Calciferol)

**List-II (Disease / Feature)** 1. Pellagra (Dermatitis, Diarrhea, Dementia)
2. Beri-Beri (Cardiovascular & nerve weakness)
3. Rickets in children & Osteomalacia in adults
4. Pernicious Anemia; contains Cobalt

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - B1 Thiamine = Beri-Beri; B3 Niacin = Pellagra; B12 Cyanocobalamin = Pernicious Anemia + Cobalt; Vitamin D = Rickets. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Cobalt is present in Vitamin B12!

---

## Question 440

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** UP Census 2011 Extremes Master Card

Match List-I (Demographic Indicator) with List-II (Extremes in Uttar Pradesh) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Indicator)** A. Highest Sex Ratio
B. Lowest Sex Ratio
C. Highest Population Density
D. Lowest Population Density

**List-II (District in UP)** 1. Gautam Buddha Nagar (851)
2. Jaunpur (1,024)
3. Lalitpur (242 persons/sq km)
4. Ghaziabad (3,971 persons/sq km)

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Highest Sex Ratio = Jaunpur (1024); Lowest Sex Ratio = GB Nagar (851); Highest Density = Ghaziabad (3971); Lowest Density = Lalitpur (242). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Highest Literacy = GB Nagar (80.1%); Lowest Literacy = Shravasti (46.7%)!

---

## Question 441

**Subject:** Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ramsar Sites of Uttar Pradesh

How many designated Ramsar Wetland Sites are currently situated in the state of Uttar Pradesh?

**Options:** A. 8
B. 10
C. 12
D. 14

**Answer:** B

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Uttar Pradesh has exactly **10 Ramsar Sites**: 1. Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora stretch, declared 2005) 2. Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Unnao, 2019) 3. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary (Rae Bareli, 2019) 4. Sandi Bird Sanctuary (Hardoi, 2019) 5. Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary (Gonda, 2019) 6. Saman Bird Sanctuary (Mainpuri, 2019) 7. Sarsai Nawar Wetland (Etawah, 2019) 8. Sur Sarovar / Keetham Lake (Agra, 2020) 9. Haiderpur Wetland (Muzaffarnagar/Bijnor, 2021) 10. Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary (Sant Kabir Nagar, 2021). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Tamil Nadu is #1 with 16 Ramsar sites; Uttar Pradesh is **#2 in India with 10 Ramsar sites**!

---

## Question 442

**Subject:** Modern Indian History | **Topic:** British Parliamentary Acts Review

Match List-I (Act) with List-II (Governor-General / Landmark Feature) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Act)** A. Regulating Act 1773
B. Charter Act 1833
C. Charter Act 1853
D. Government of India Act 1858

**List-II (Feature / Title)** 1. First Governor-General of India (Lord William Bentinck); ended commercial monopoly entirely
2. First Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings); Supreme Court at Calcutta
3. Abolished East India Company; British Crown assumed direct sovereignty; Viceroy (Lord Canning)
4. Introduced open competition for Indian Civil Services; separated executive and legislative councils

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - 1773 = Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings); 1833 = Governor-General of India (William Bentinck); 1853 = Open competition for ICS; 1858 = Viceroy of India (Lord Canning). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** First GG of Bengal = Warren Hastings; First GG of India = William Bentinck; First Viceroy = Lord Canning!

## Question 443

**Subject:** Indian Economy | **Topic:** Five-Year Plans & Architecture

Match List-I (Five-Year Plan) with List-II (Core Model / Main Objective) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Plan)** A. First Plan (1951–56)
B. Second Plan (1956–61)
C. Third Plan (1961–66)
D. Twelfth Plan (2012–17)

**List-II (Model / Objective)** 1. P.C. Mahalanobis Model; rapid heavy industrialization
2. Harrod-Domar Model; agriculture and price stability
3. Faster, Sustainable, and More Inclusive Growth
4. Gadgil Yojana; self-reliant and self-generating growth

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - 1st Plan = Harrod-Domar; 2nd Plan = Mahalanobis; 3rd Plan = Gadgil; 12th Plan = Faster, Sustainable, More Inclusive Growth. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Plan Holidays occurred between **1966 and 1969** following the 3rd Plan failure!

## Question 444

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Nobel Prize in Literature 2024

South Korean novelist Han Kang, awarded the 2024 Nobel Prize in Literature, is best known internationally for which acclaimed novel?

**Options:** A. *The Vegetarian*
B. *Pachinko*
C. *Please Look After Mom*
D. *Kim Jiyoung, Born 1982*

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Han Kang** won the 2016 International Booker Prize and global fame for her novel ***The Vegetarian*** (translated into English by Deborah Smith). - Awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature in October 2024 for her intense poetic prose confronting historical traumas. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** *Pachinko* was written by Min Jin Lee; *The Vegetarian* is by Han Kang!

## Question 445

**Subject:** Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Buddhist Councils Master Sequence

Match List-I (Buddhist Council) with List-II (Patron King & Venue) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Council)** A. First Council (483 BCE)
B. Second Council (383 BCE)
C. Third Council (250 BCE)
D. Fourth Council (72 CE)

**List-II (King & City)** 1. Kalashoka; Vaishali
2. Ajatashatru; Rajgriha (Sattapanni Cave)
3. Kanishka; Kundalvana (Kashmir)
4. Ashoka; Pataliputra

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - 1st: Ajatashatru at Rajgriha; 2nd: Kalashoka at Vaishali; 3rd: Ashoka at Pataliputra; 4th: Kanishka in Kashmir. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Kings mnemonic: **AK-AK** (Ajatashatru -> Kalashoka -> Ashoka -> Kanishka)! Places mnemonic: **R-V-P-K** (Rajgriha -> Vaishali -> Pataliputra -> Kashmir).

## Question 446

**Subject:** World Geography | **Topic:** Local Winds Character

Match List-I (Local Wind) with List-II (Distinct Meteorological Trait) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Wind)** A. Chinook
B. Sirocco
C. Harmattan
D. Loo

**List-II (Trait)** 1. Hot, dry summer wind of the northern Indian Gangetic plains causing heat strokes
2. Warm, dry katabatic wind of Rocky Mountains known as "Snow Eater"
3. Dry, dust-laden trade wind on the Guinea Coast of Africa known as "The Doctor"
4. Hot, humid, dust-bearing wind from Sahara blowing towards Italy causing "Blood Rain"

**Options:** A. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
B. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
D. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Chinook = Rockies "Snow Eater"; Sirocco = Italy "Blood Rain"; Harmattan = Guinea Coast "The Doctor"; Loo = North India summer heat wind. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Foehn is in the European Alps; Chinook is in the North American Rockies!

## Question 447

**Subject:** Indian Polity | **Topic:** Constitutional Offices & Articles Final Review

Match List-I (Constitutional Authority) with List-II (Article) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Authority)** A. Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG)
B. Finance Commission
C. Election Commission of India
D. Attorney General for India

**List-II (Article)** 1. Article 280
2. Article 148
3. Article 76
4. Article 324

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - CAG = Art 148; Finance Commission = Art 280; Election Commission = Art 324; Attorney General = Art 76. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Advocate General of the State is under **Article 165**!

## Question 448

**Subject:** General Science (Chemistry) | **Topic:** Commercial Polymers Final Match

Match List-I (Commercial Polymer) with List-II (Distinct Property / Application) and select the correct answer:

**List-I (Polymer)** A. Teflon
B. Bakelite
C. PVC
D. Natural Rubber

**List-II (Application / Property)** 1. Thermosetting plastic of Phenol-Formaldehyde; electrical switches and appliance handles
2. Polytetrafluoroethylene; non-stick coating for cookware
3. Polymer of Isoprene; vulcanized with sulfur for elasticity
4. Polyvinyl chloride; pipes, conduit tubing, and raincoats

**Options:** A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

**Answer:** A

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Teflon = Non-stick cookware; Bakelite = Thermosetting switches; PVC = Pipes; Natural Rubber = Isoprene. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Bakelite is THERMOSETTING (irreversible); PVC is THERMOPLASTIC (recyclable)!

---

## Question 449

**Subject:** Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Tiger Reserves of Uttar Pradesh

How many Tiger Reserves are currently notified in Uttar Pradesh under Project Tiger?

**Options:** A. 2
B. 3
C. 4
D. 5

**Answer:** C

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Uttar Pradesh currently has **4 Tiger Reserves**: 1. **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve:** Lakhimpur Kheri (includes Kishanpur WLS and Katerniaghat WLS). 2. **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve:** Pilibhit and Shahjahanpur districts (won international TX2 award). 3. **Amangarh Tiger Reserve:** Bijnor district (buffer of Jim Corbett National Park). 4. **Ranipur Tiger Reserve:** Chitrakoot district in Bundelkhand (notified in 2022 as UP's 4th Tiger Reserve and India's 53rd Tiger Reserve). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Ranipur Tiger Reserve is in **Chitrakoot district**, situated in the dry deciduous forests of Bundelkhand!

---

## Question 450

**Subject:** Current Affairs | **Topic:** Grand Cultural & Literary Honours

Consider the following statements regarding premier national honors: 1. The 58th Jnanpith Award was conferred jointly upon Gulzar (Urdu) and Jagadguru Rambhadracharya (Sanskrit). 2. The 33rd Saraswati Samman was conferred on noted Malayalam poet Prabha Varma for his work *Roudrasathwikam*. 3. The Booker Prize 2024 was awarded to Samantha Harvey for *Orbital*.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

**Options:** A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer:** D

**Explanation:** - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **58th Jnanpith Award:** Jointly honored poet/filmmaker **Gulzar** and Sanskrit scholar **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya**. - **33rd Saraswati Samman:** Malayalam poet **Prabha Varma** for verse novel *Roudrasathwikam*. - **Booker Prize 2024:** British author **Samantha Harvey** for her space-themed novel *Orbital*. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** All 450 questions have covered the complete high-yield syllabus matrix across History, Geography, Polity, Science, Environment, Economy, UP Special, and Current Affairs with maximum recurrence probability for UPPSC Prelims!